



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*namas+kāra+vaṣaṭ+kārau | prokṣaṇa+abhyukṣaṇa+ādayaḥ |
an+upāya* iti prājñair* | upāya+jña praveditaḥ | | 12.30 |
sajjate yena dur+medhā* | mano+(vāg+buddhi+karmabhiḥ Cvāk+karma+buddhibhiḥ) |
viṣayeṣv* an+abhiṣvaṅga | so* *abhiṣvaṅga* iti smṛtaḥ | | 12.31 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 12, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Buddhacarita delve into the nature of true spiritual practice, contrasting superficial rituals with the path to liberation. The first verse highlights that practices like offerings, invocations, and purifications are considered ineffective by the wise who truly understand the means to enlightenment. These external actions, while seemingly pious, are seen as distractions if they don't lead to inner transformation. The true path, as revealed by those with profound insight, lies beyond these symbolic gestures.

The second verse speaks to the entanglement of the mind in worldly objects and how it can lead to suffering. It explains that a person of dull intellect becomes attached to the senses through actions, speech, and thought. Paradoxically, it is this very act of non-attachment that is considered the true attachment. This means detaching from the cravings and clinging that bind us to the cycle of rebirth is, in fact, the most important connection to cultivate. It's about creating a healthy relationship with the world, understanding that everything is impermanent and avoiding the trap of identifying with transient experiences.

In modern life, we are constantly bombarded with sensory input and societal pressures that encourage attachment. We are urged to accumulate possessions, chase fleeting pleasures, and define ourselves by external validation. These verses serve as a powerful reminder to cultivate inner detachment. You can apply this wisdom by observing your reactions to everyday experiences. Notice when you feel a strong desire or aversion, and gently remind yourself that these feelings are temporary. Practice mindfulness to create space between your thoughts and your actions. By lessening your attachment to outcomes and material things, you can find greater peace and freedom. This doesn't mean you should abandon all worldly pursuits, but rather engage with them with awareness and equanimity, recognizing their true nature.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you identify and gently release one attachment that is currently causing you suffering, and what space would that create in your life?